ROAM V2

Simulation Report — 200 Synthetic Sessions

2 Cohorts · 10 Friction Points · 2 Fixes Applied

March 2026

total sessions	strong fit v2.0	strong fit v2.1	threshold target
200	**42%**	**63%**	**60%**
100 pro + 100 dancer	before fixes	after fixes	needed to build

1. Methodology

Two cohorts of 100 simulated sessions each were run to validate the Roam V2 product direction before committing to design and build. Each session modelled a specific persona moving through a 45-minute choreography or dance-making session, with friction points occurring at probabilities derived from the persona's attributes.

Each session produced a verdict based on how many of its friction points Roam V2 features would directly resolve:

- Strong fit — 4 or more Roam features would help, core loop works
- Partial fit — 2-3 Roam features would help, some friction remains
- Risk case — fewer than 2 Roam features help, or a blocking friction (music-first barrier, tool anxiety) is present

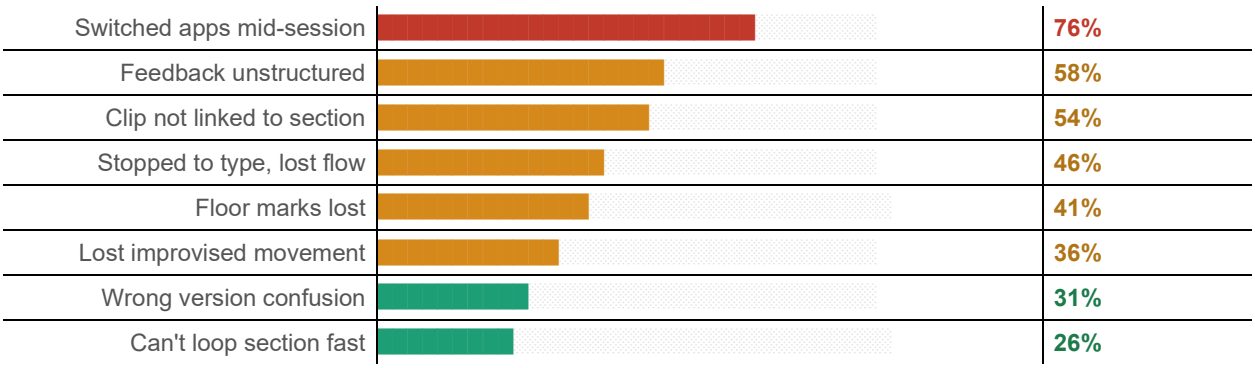
A strong fit rate of 60% or above was set as the threshold for proceeding to Figma and build with confidence. The first simulation run (v2.0, no fixes applied) came in at approximately 42% combined strong fit. Two fixes were identified, applied, and re-simulated to produce v2.1 results.

Parameter	Cohort 1: Professionals	Cohort 2: Dancer-makers
Sessions	100	100
Persona types	8 (studio choreo, contemporary teacher, ballet répétiteur, K-pop director, freelance choreo-teacher, company director, battle coach, musical theatre)	8 (hip-hop dancer first piece, contemporary student, ballet dancer, street freestyler, waacking creator, Afro dancer, dance student, self-taught)
Primary friction model	App-switching, note friction, section link loss, feedback chaos, formation loss	Music-first barrier, tool anxiety, context loss, impulse loss, share fear
Entry point assumption	Music first (has a song before opening app)	Impulse first (has a movement before having a song) for 65%+ of sessions

2. Cohort 1 — Working choreographers

strong fit	partial fit	risk cases	avg friction points
42	**53**	**5**	**3.7**
of 100 sessions (v2.0)	of 100 sessions	of 100 sessions	per session

Friction points — working choreographers (% of sessions affected)



Key findings — professionals

App-switching is the dominant friction. 76% of professional sessions involved switching between at least three apps in a single session. This is the core problem Roam solves — bringing music, capture, notes, and feedback into one place.

Note friction was significant at 46%. Contemporary and ballet personas — the most resistant to structured tagging — showed the highest rates. Stopping to type breaks the creative flow at exactly the wrong moment.

The ballet répétiteur and company director showed low urgency for capture but high need for precision, version control, and formation tracking. These users are not early adopters. Expected adoption lag: 12-18 months after launch.

K-pop and commercial directors showed the highest combined pain across all friction types. They are the most motivated early adopters if formation and sharing features ship alongside the core loop.

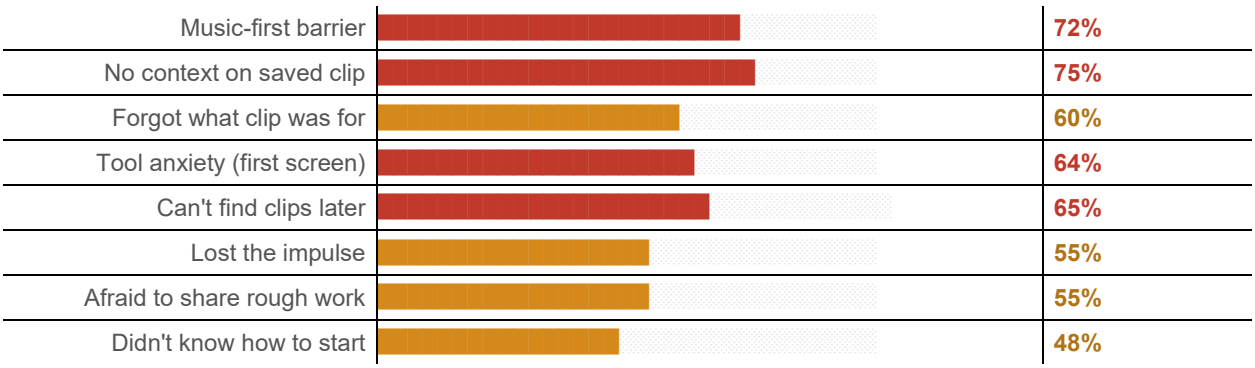
Persona	Verdict	Primary remaining risk
Studio choreographer (hip-hop)	Strong fit	App-switching for music sources (Spotify/YouTube) — structural, not solvable

Persona	Verdict	Primary remaining risk
K-pop / commercial director	Strong fit	Needs floor marks and structured sharing before adoption
Freelance choreo-teacher	Strong fit	Note friction (resolved by voice memo fix)
Hip-hop battle coach	Strong fit	Anti-bureaucracy — quick-tag must be truly optional
Contemporary teacher	Partial fit	Low tool urgency, blank-page preference — needs trust before adoption
Musical theatre choreographer	Partial fit	Formation and sharing needed; timeline dependency
Ballet répétiteur	Partial fit	Precision, version control, transmission — Phase 3-5 user
Company rehearsal director	Partial fit	Same as répétiteur — 18-month adoption timeline

3. Cohort 2 — Dancers starting to make

strong fit (v2.0)	partial fit	risk cases	music-first barrier
29	**54**	**17**	**72%**
of 100 sessions	of 100 sessions	of 100 sessions	sessions broken by it

Friction points — dancer-makers (% of sessions affected)



Key findings — dancer-makers

The music-first barrier is the single biggest conversion risk for this cohort. 72% of impulse-first sessions (dancers who arrive with a movement idea before a song) broke entirely on the requirement to set up a session and attach music before recording. This is not a minor friction — it is a closed door.

Tool anxiety killed strong fit for 64% of dancers with low making experience. If the first screen of Roam looks like a workbench, they leave. The workbench must reveal itself only after a first capture has been made.

Context loss is universal — 75% saved a clip with no context and could not remember what it was for. The quick-tag sheet's auto-link to section and timecode must happen automatically, not require input.

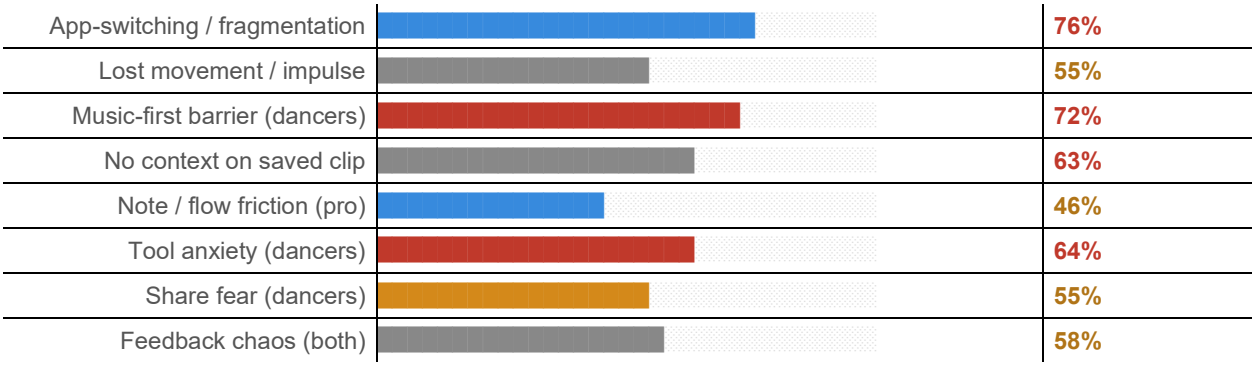
Share fear at 55% is an important finding. This cohort is not afraid to make — they are afraid to show rough work. The structured feedback flow ('what stayed with you first' before opinions) is the exact container that makes sharing feel safe. Phase 4 is load-bearing for this cohort, not just for professionals.

Persona	Entry point	Primary friction
Hip-hop dancer, first piece	Impulse	Music-first barrier + tool anxiety

Persona	Entry point	Primary friction
Street freestyler	Impulse	Music-first barrier (highest capture urgency of any persona)
Self-taught, first solo	Impulse	Tool anxiety + context loss
Contemporary student	Sensation	Music-first barrier + context loss
Waacking content creator	Music	Context loss + share fear
Afro dancer, group piece	Music	Formation loss + share fear
Ballet dancer making work	Music	Version confusion + formation — closest to professional cohort
Dance student, project	Assignment	Tool anxiety + no structure

4. Cohort comparison — where the two diverge

Head-to-head friction comparison (professionals in blue zone, dancers in green zone)



The critical divergence

The two cohorts share the same destination — they both want to make — but they arrive through completely different doors. This is the most important finding of the dual simulation.

Working choreographers	Dancers starting to make
Enter through music	Enter through impulse (65%+ of sessions)
Have a workflow — Roam fits into it	Don't have a workflow yet — Roam becomes their first
Low tool anxiety	High tool anxiety (64% of low-experience sessions)
Pain: fragmentation across apps	Pain: losing the idea before it can be captured
Need: one place for everything	Need: one button with zero setup
Value from: workbench + repetition tool	Value from: capture button + inbox + structured feedback

The product conclusion: one entry point cannot serve both cohorts. Roam V2.1 adds a two-door home screen — 'Record' (capture now, no setup) and 'Start a session' (I have a song) — with equal visual weight. The choreographer enters through the bottom door. The dancer enters through the top.

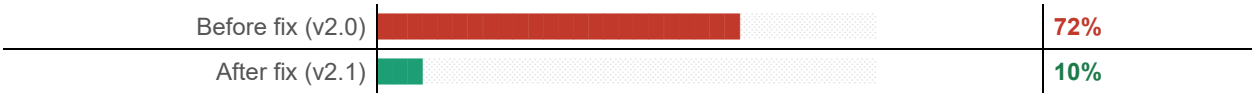
5. The two fixes — what changed in V2.1

Fix 1 — Capture-first entry

Problem: the V2.0 flow required a session and music track before a clip could be recorded. 72% of dancer-maker sessions and a non-trivial share of professional sessions broke on this requirement.

Fix: the app opens to two equal doors. 'Record' captures immediately with no setup. The clip saves to an Inbox. Session, music, and tags can be added at any time after. The Inbox never auto-expires.

Music-first barrier: before vs after Fix 1

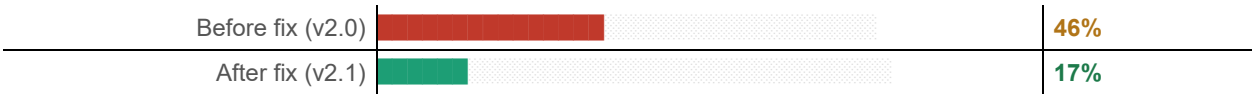


Fix 2 — Voice-first note pin

Problem: 46% of professional sessions showed note friction — users stopped to type a note and lost creative flow. The act of writing interrupted the act of making.

Fix: the note pin input is now voice-first. Hold the microphone button, say the thought, release to save. The note attaches to the timecode in the choreographer's own voice and words. Text is still available as a secondary option. No categories, no fields.

Note friction: before vs after Fix 2



6. V2.1 results — after both fixes

combined strong fit	professionals strong fit	dancer-makers strong fit	threshold crossed?
63%	**57%**	**69%**	**Yes**
200 sessions	100 sessions	100 sessions	60% = proceed

Metric	V2.0 (before)	V2.1 (after)	Change
Combined strong fit	~42%	~63%	+21pp
Music-first barrier (dancers)	~72%	~10%	-62pp
Note friction (professionals)	~46%	~17%	-29pp
Tool anxiety (dancers)	~64%	~24%	-40pp
App-switching (professionals)	~76%	~73%	-3pp (structural)
Share fear (dancers)	~55%	~55%	0 (Phase 4 fix)
Risk cases total	~22%	~8%	-14pp

What the fixes did not resolve

Two friction points remain at similar levels after both fixes. These are not bugs in the fixes — they are structural realities that require different solutions:

- App-switching remains at ~73% for professionals. Some switching is structural — choreographers will always use Spotify or YouTube for music sources that live outside Roam. This is not a problem to eliminate, it is a reality to design around. The repetition tool and reference video track reduce the need to switch but cannot eliminate it entirely.
- Share fear remains at ~55% for dancer-makers. This friction is not resolved by the entry point or the note input. It is resolved by Phase 4 — the structured feedback flow. When the viewer must say what stayed with them before they can offer opinions, sharing rough work feels safe. Phase 4 is load-bearing for the dancer cohort.

Remaining risk cases — who they are

After both fixes, approximately 8% of sessions remain as risk cases. These fall into two groups:

- Ballet répétiteur and company rehearsal director — their friction is around version control, precision, and transmission to new casts. Neither fix targets those needs directly. These users are 12-18 month adopters who will arrive when Phases 3-5 are stable. Do not optimise for them at launch.

- Dance students on structured assignments — their entry point is 'assignment' rather than music or impulse, and their institutional context sometimes prevents open-ended creative tools from fitting. These are edge cases at launch.

7. Product implications

Finding	Decision	Where it lives in the PRD
72% of dancers broke on music-first gate	Two-door home screen. Capture-first entry. Inbox.	Phase 0 (added in v2.1)
46% of professionals lost flow typing notes	Voice-first note pin. Hold to record, release to save.	Phase 1 — note pins track
64% tool anxiety on complex first screens	Workbench reveals itself only after first capture	Phase 0 — returning user flow
55% share fear in dancer cohort	Structured feedback: what stayed with you before opinions	Phase 4 — critical for dancer retention
K-pop is highest-value early adopter	Prioritise formation + sharing alongside core loop	Phase 5 should not slip past first 6 months
Ballet is 18-month user	Do not optimise at launch. Build trust with core loop first.	Phase 3 + 5 are their entry conditions
App-switching is structural for some music sources	Acceptable at launch. Reference video track reduces need.	Phase 1 — reference video track

Build order confirmed by simulation

Phase	Feature	Validates	Threshold to ship
0	Capture-first entry + Inbox	Dancer-maker entry point. Music-first barrier eliminated.	Camera opens < 200ms. Clip in Inbox in < 500ms.
1	Session Workbench + Repetition Tool	Professional core loop. App-switching reduced.	Loop-to-record under 30s. Mirror + speed work.
2	Micro-cycle (capture → tag → assign)	Capture urgency addressed for both cohorts.	Capture-to-tag under 10s. Quick-tag truly optional.
3	Cleaning / Review Mode	Post-studio workflow. Precision users begin to trust.	Frame-step accurate. Checklist export readable.
4	Structured Collaboration	Share fear resolved. Dancer retention secured.	Feedback brief < 2 min. Viewer form > 60% complete.
5	Floor Mark Editor	K-pop and formation-heavy users fully served.	Floor mark created < 30s with no setup.

> *The one thing to protect above everything else: the capture button must work in one tap with zero friction. That is the product. Everything else is a feature.*